Describe, agree, resolve

Shared procedures / Read with Create; DMs also use Run.

Your game, your creations

Players portray their characters; the Dungeon Master (DM) portrays the world and its other inhabitants. Together, agree the setting, tone, boundaries, starting level and equipment. Use dice, a character record and these core sheets. Paper play needs no account or website.

SwordWeave invites you to invent personal characters and workings. **Create SwordWeave** supplies the character and primitive rules; **Run SwordWeave** supplies monsters, encounters and advancement. The longer books offer more explanation and examples.

The procedure for any attempt

1. **Say the result you want.** "I divert the current so the worker can cross."
2. **Establish what makes it possible.** Ordinary tools and circumstances can suffice. Extraordinary changes need the relevant owned permissions or an explicit table exception.
3. **Describe the expression.** Locate the target; establish reach, path, recipients, output, timing and anything that continues.
4. **Agree the stakes before committing.** State uncertainty, success, failure, Cost and when it applies. Accept, narrow or revise the attempt.
5. **Resolve, then carry the changes forward.** Roll only for actual uncertainty. Apply the agreed outcome and consequences; continue from the changed scene.

Rule of Cool. Give exciting ideas a chance. Agree a coherent exception and its scope when useful. An exceptional result grants only what the table actually agreed.

Permission, scale and Cost

A **Primitive** grants an actual rule or permission. An Effect groups ingredients or outcomes; a Capability organizes a working or talent. These arrangements do not grant unstated mechanics or force a nesting chain.

CONTINUED / PERMISSION, SCALE AND COST

Verb concerns the change; Domain the subject; Structure the arrangement; Range the reach; Output the eligible die type. Read the bound rule. Water access is not access to every physical substance. More Cost does not silently supply missing behavior.

Ordinary acts need no primitive for every task: lifting a bucket is ordinary competence. Remote water control is a different permission. More volume, dice, recipients or duration can increase pressure within access; new behavior can require new access.

Choose the question to resolve

Actual uncertainty	Procedure
Is the result secure?	Describe it; no compulsory roll.
Can I accomplish a task?	Check against an agreed DC.
Does my attack hit?	Attack against target DC.
Does the recipient resist?	Relevant save against user's DC.
Which intent happens first?	Clash; shared-round procedure.
Whose opposed effort wins?	Contest; shared-round procedure.

Check or attack: roll d20 + relevant current attribute + applicable training + qualifying modifiers. Meeting the Difficulty Class (**DC**) succeeds. An attack then resolves its stated damage/effect; a miss deals no hit damage unless stated.

Save: the recipient rolls d20 + relevant current attribute + actual save training + qualifying save modifiers against the user's DC. Follow the working's stated or agreed success/failure result. An attack and a save are alternatives unless that working explicitly requires both.

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Permission, timing and reactions

Shared procedures / Read with Create; DMs also use Run.

Read a bonus once

Physical, Mental and Magical use their full current values. **PB** means proficiency bonus. Your chosen proficient attribute supplies PB to all its practices and its save. Additional practice training does not automatically train a save. Proficiency adds PB; eligible expertise adds twice PB. Repeated grants of the same training do not add PB repeatedly.

Applicable contributions stack unless their actual conditions, uniqueness or stacking rules prevent it. Apply authored floors, ceilings and fixed results only to their specified quantity. There is no default natural-20 success, natural-1 failure or critical multiplier. Ordinary rounding goes upward; explicit floor formulas retain their stated rounding.

Advantage and disadvantage / Bias

Apply restrictions, then cancel opposing stacks one for one. With **N** remaining advantage stacks, roll **N + 1** resolution dice and keep the highest; with disadvantage, keep the lowest. With none, roll one die. Add the static bonus once.

> **Worked roll.** Mira has Magical 4 and PB 2 training: bonus +6. Two advantages and one disadvantage leave one advantage. She rolls 2d20, keeps 7 rather than 3, then adds 6: **13**, meeting agreed DC 12. Water 1 is not purchased again for this use.

Council, then three tracks

Phase	What happens
Council	Coordinate intent, clarify dependencies and address upkeep at its agreed due point. Refresh the ordinary independent Reaction Slot.
Fast	Resolve Complexity 0–1.
Measured	Resolve Complexity 2–3.
Heavy	Resolve Complexity 4+.

CONTINUED / COUNCIL, THEN THREE TRACKS

Declare **one coherent Main Intent** and establish its dependent actions. Complexity describes dependencies and timing, not damage or power. There is no default initiative roll. A large result is not automatically Heavy; a dependency cannot be skipped simply by claiming speed.

At the next Council, update the scene and declare from the new facts. A new round refreshes the ordinary reaction and movement allowance; it does not erase wounds, consequences or ongoing work.

Clash versus Contest

A **Reaction Clash** answers which colliding opposing intent happens first within a track when timing matters. Each rolls d20 + relevant attribute + applicable training/modifiers; higher goes first. On a tie, the GM resolves simultaneously or follows the stronger fictional position. Losing does not automatically erase a Main Intent; pivot if the scene has changed.

An **Active Contest** answers whose directly opposed effort prevails: each side rolls its relevant approach and the higher wins the immediate struggle. Agree the actual stakes. Use combined practice totals once. If a contest tie has no authored outcome, agree its treatment from the situation; do not invent an automatic victory.

React to an actual trigger

One independent **Reaction Slot** resets at Council. A default reaction needs a valid trigger, immediate Complexity 0–1, and self/touch or single-target scope. Actual access, position and timing still apply.

Pause the triggering event, resolve the valid response, then continue. A reaction can occur before or after your Main Intent; it does not automatically cancel the trigger or provide fresh movement. Instant actions cannot be interrupted retroactively after resolution; an ongoing result can be separately disrupted with suitable access.

Optional surprise guidance. There is no universal surprise rule. Circumstances may support one prepared round before others respond; an agreed check or different circumstances can change that treatment.

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Movement, Cost and continuing work

Shared procedures / Read with Create; DMs also use Run.

Locate, reach, deliver

First locate a specific target through an applicable sense: sight, a granted sense, or another actual targeting method. Hearing a sound does not always pinpoint its maker. Without a located target, propose a known spot or area and resolve uncertainty. The desired creature is not guaranteed to be there.

Then check reach. Range supplies no information and bypasses no sensory requirement. A genuinely authored alternative, such as scrying or "any qualifying target within range," must establish its own method.

Range permission	Default reach
Touch	Self, contact or appropriate ordinary melee reach.
Near	Up to 30 ft.
Far	Up to 60 ft.
Very Far	Up to 120 ft.
Extreme	Continuous reach up to about 3 miles, including nearer targets; DM extension possible.

Projected delivery travels through intervening space: minor obstruction gives -2 accuracy, half cover -4, and total cover blocks the trajectory. Judge the actual angle and route.

Direct manifestation can avoid those projected-cover penalties only when the actual working supports it. It still needs legitimate target location and access. Range alone does not grant direct manifestation. Area, selectivity and targets must fit actual permissions; allies are not automatically excluded.

Movement belongs to the whole round

Speed is your ordinary movement allowance across Fast, Measured, Heavy and valid reactions together. Move with an intent or independently as circumstances permit. Record what you have already spent. Neither another track nor a Reaction Slot refills it.

CONTINUED / MOVEMENT BELONGS TO THE WHOLE ROUND

Example. With Speed 30 ft, moving 10 ft in Fast leaves 20 ft for the rest of that round. Moving farther requires suitable speed access or an agreed Cost/consequence.

Ordinary swim/climb is half walking Speed rounded up. Flight and burrowing need access. Size defaults and carrying/equipment rules are in **Create**. Routes, hazards and interference still matter.

> **One changed scene.** Mira first redirects water; her ally crosses only once the safe route exists. If an opponent opens the gate before that diversion, update the route and stakes. The declared plan is not protection from changed circumstances.

Agree Cost before commitment

BU (Build Units) pays for reusable acquisitions. **Item BU** tracks equipment mechanics separately. **Cost** is the pressure or consequence of using something now. Unspent BU is not automatically mana; neither CV nor BU is added to a d20.

Cost can be negligible, Vitality, material, numerical, restrictive, environmental or narrative; combinations are possible. Establish its amount or actual change, timing and ending. State what failure and interruption mean; there is no universal refund.

Strain 0–6 guides appraisal: effortless; light effort; noticeable strain; heavy burden; dangerous instability; critical risk; catastrophic consequence. These grades are not fixed bills or success probabilities. Consider scale, recipients, output, urgency, dependencies, opposition and ordinary support.

Optional evaluation. For minimum evaluated composition B and selected evaluated use A, increase = A - B and total CV = A. If B is 12 and A is 30, increase is 18 and total is 30. This is an appraisal aid, not a compulsory Vitality conversion.

Write consequences people can follow

Record **cause; actual change; timing/trigger; ending/recovery.** A label such as "frozen" imports no standard package. State who is affected and what they can still do.

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Damage, rescue and recovery

Shared procedures / Read with Create; DMs also use Run.

CONTINUED / WRITE CONSEQUENCES PEOPLE CAN FOLLOW

Example. "While Mira directs this diverted channel, she cannot use this working for a separate diversion. It ends when she releases it or the repair removes the need." This specific restriction is not a universal one-capability limit.

Continue and interfere

Track, duration and upkeep are separate. A maintained capability has one upkeep track even with several effects. Several capabilities may coexist; their agreed requirements accumulate. Agree when each continuation is due, such as Council.

Maintenance generally spreads pressure or reduces upfront demand compared with forcing the same increased expression at once; no fixed discount applies. Someone unable to perform a required task cannot continue it. Interference needs access, position, timing and resolution. A hit alone does not end all maintained work.

> **Pending alpha rule.** Additional incoming-damage-triggered Vitality repayment, thresholds and counter/reset handling remain undecided. These sheets impose no such scheme. Use ordinary agreed continuation; identify any temporary table variation explicitly.

Apply the actual damage

Read source (**Physical, Magical, Psychic**) and domain separately; Mental is an attribute. Matching resistance halves damage rounded up; vulnerability doubles it; immunity negates covered damage. Resistance and vulnerability cancel on the same instance; repeated resistance does not quarter it. Damage immunity does not automatically prevent associated conditions.

Define split portions or separate instances before applying defenses. **Example:** 9 Magical Fire becomes 5 with matching resistance, 18 with vulnerability, 9 with both. Six Physical Fire plus eight Magical Fire becomes 10 with Magical-only resistance: 6 + 4.

CONTINUED / APPLY THE ACTUAL DAMAGE

Subtract final damage from current Vitality. Healing cannot exceed maximum; increasing maximum alone does not heal.

At zero / rescue is urgent

At zero Vitality you collapse, unconscious and incapacitated. Establish a contextual rescue countdown; roughly a minute is guidance, not ten guaranteed safe rounds.

An ally dedicates an action track to **Fieldcraft stabilization** or suitable owned primitives. Agree access, time, resolution and Cost; no universal stabilization DC or mandatory training gate is supplied. Stabilization halts the countdown without healing or waking. Healing above zero ends dying and wakes you unless another consequence prevents it. Stabilized characters may recover through assisted rest; active dying needs rescue first.

Massive damage: one execution dealing at least twice maximum Vitality, or taking pre-hit current Vitality to negative maximum, can cause immediate death. Establish lethal stakes beforehand. Compare before a sheet clamps the value to zero. With max 13/current 4, final damage 17 reaches -13; final damage 26 separately meets twice maximum.

Short and long rests

The table agrees when circumstances earn recovery; time alone does not apply it. A short rest may be a 15- or 30-minute pause. A long rest is overnight sleep or equivalent, without a compulsory eight-hour timer.

Short rest: between completed long rests, a finite recovery allowance equals half maximum Vitality rounded up. Heal only missing Vitality, up to the remaining allowance and agreed restoration. Spend only points actually healed; carry unused points into later short rests.

Example: max 13 gives allowance 7. At 10/13, restore 3 and retain 4. Another pause does not refill it.

Long rest: normally restore to maximum and refresh the short-rest allowance. Its healing does not spend that allowance. Agree any partial healing explicitly, including what a percentage measures. Lingering injuries and other consequences retain their own endings.

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